

Premium Ready computer requires a 1 GHz processor, 1 GB of RAM, and a graphics card with at least 128 MB of memory (DX9-compatible too, as well as one with the correct WDDM drivers). Such a Premium Ready PC will take advantage of Vista's high-end features.

Essentially, Windows Vista's Basic interface will work with virtually any graphics hardware that supports Windows XP or 2000. Also offered is the Windows Vista Classic look, which essentially offers the same UI as Windows 2000 does. While a PCI-Express video card is not a requirement for Windows Aero, Microsoft recommends one over an AGP device due to the greater bandwidth of the interface.

1.4 Changes For Vista Deployment

Quite a few changes have been made to the manner in which you can deploy a Vista image. These changes are made throughout the deployment system—from the nature of the image file used to the tools support this new format. Let's take a look at the broad changes that have been made to make deployment and component change easier:

1.4.1. Windows Vista And Images

While deploying a version of Vista for your business, one of the most important points to keep in mind is that the nature of the install has changed in several ways: Vista essentially installs off an image file, which is compressed on the DVD media it ships with. Installation thus is a two-step process of first copying this image file to disc and then decompressing it and installing the drivers etc. This also means that the size of the image for Vista deployment has gone through the roof: while you could deploy an XP install on a single CD, the basic image size of Vista itself is close to 2 GB, compressed at that. The uncompressed version of the same can easily span more than 5 GB. Add to this additional programs